

# Analysis of Recent DDoS Attacks

## 1. Tbps UDP Flood Attack (Mid-May 2025)

- **Target:** Hosting provider protected by Cloudflare's infrastructure.
- **Technology Used:** UDP flood attack peaking at 11.5 terabits per second (Tbps) and 5.1 billion packets per second (Bpps), originating from over 122,000 IP addresses across IoT devices and cloud providers, including some from Google Cloud Platform (not primary source). Attack lasted approximately 45 seconds, delivering 37.4 terabytes of traffic.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Unknown; no specific attribution or stated intent reported.
- **Overall Impact:** Short duration limited long-term disruption, but scale demonstrated potential for massive resource exhaustion. Part of 27.8 million DDoS incidents mitigated by Cloudflare in the first half of 2025, surpassing 2024's total.
- **Defensive Strategies:** Cloudflare's autonomous detection and mitigation systems blocked the attack without manual intervention. Recommended strategies include cloud-based DDoS protection services for scalable traffic filtering, rate limiting, and IP blocking from known abusive sources like compromised IoT networks.

## 2. Crimean Communication Blackout (Third Week of July 2025)

- **Target:** Fixed-line communication operators in occupied Crimea, primarily Miranda Media (Rostelecom subsidiary) in Sevastopol, affecting telecommunications infrastructure.
- **Technology Used:** Massive DDoS attack causing periodic service unavailability, similar to prior Ukrainian cyber operations.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Attributed to Ukraine's Main Intelligence Directorate (HUR) to degrade Russian administrative and military control in occupied territories, impose economic pressure, and showcase cyber capabilities without kinetic action.
- **Overall Impact:** Disrupted services for thousands of residents and businesses, complicating administrative and military coordination, and eroding confidence in Russian authorities' protective capabilities.
- **Defensive Strategies:** Could include redundant network architectures, traffic scrubbing services to filter DDoS floods, and geographic diversification of infrastructure to reduce single points of failure in high-risk regions.

## 3. Attack on The Kyiv Independent (July 22-23, 2025)

- **Target:** The Kyiv Independent, an independent Ukrainian media outlet, specifically its admin dashboard and online services.
- **Technology Used:** DDoS attack generating over 10,000 requests per second, timed to coincide with sensitive editorial coverage.
- **Attacker's Motive:** To suppress critical journalism following an editorial criticizing Ukrainian President Zelensky's legislative actions; suggests state-affiliated actors aiming for a chilling effect on investigative reporting through information warfare.

- **Overall Impact:** Caused slowdowns and partial outages in the admin dashboard, but public-facing content remained mostly accessible; created symbolic pressure on media freedom and highlighted timing-sensitive cyber vulnerabilities.
- **Defensive Strategies:** Distributed content delivery network (CDN) and built-in mitigation measures ensured resilience. Additional strategies include web application firewalls (WAFs) for request rate limiting, anomaly detection for traffic spikes, and incident response plans with quick failover to backup systems.

#### 4. Attack on Russian Restaurant Chains (July 18, 2025)

- **Target:** Shared technology infrastructure of automation provider iiko and hosting partner ESTT, impacting chains like Vkusno i Tochka, Cofix, and Sushi Master.
- **Technology Used:** Coordinated DDoS campaign exploiting supply chain vulnerabilities in point-of-sale systems, inventory management, and customer apps, targeting shared hosting for amplified effects.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Economic warfare to impose costs on Russia's post-sanctions food service sector, erode civilian morale, and expand cyber disruptions; likely Ukrainian-aligned targeting commercial vulnerabilities.
- **Overall Impact:** Paralyzed operations across dozens of businesses for five days, causing complete disruptions and cascading supply chain effects, exposing commercial sector unpreparedness.
- **Defensive Strategies:** Recommended measures include distributed architectures for critical systems, regular vulnerability assessments of third-party providers, capacity planning for sustained attacks, and DDoS protection via traffic diversion to scrubbing centers.

#### 5. NoName057(16) DDoS Campaigns Using DDoSia (Ongoing, July 2024–July 2025)

- **Target:** Over 3,700 unique hosts, primarily government and public-sector entities in Ukraine (29%) and European allies (France, Italy, Sweden, Germany, Israel, Czech Republic, Poland); sectors include transportation, logistics, technology, media, and communications.
- **Technology Used:** Custom DDoSia tool (Go-based) for application-layer attacks, including HTTP GET floods (15.4%), TCP floods (SYN 17.6%, ACK 16.1%), and slow-loris variants (31.5%); volunteer-driven via Telegram with multi-tier C2 servers for resilience and encrypted target distribution.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Pro-Russian hacktivism aligned with Russia's invasion of Ukraine, retaliating against adversaries for sanctions, military support, or statements; acts as a non-financially motivated asset in hybrid warfare.
- **Overall Impact:** Sustained disruptions to critical infrastructure, eroding civic trust; peaks tied to events like Ukraine's Kursk offensive, with an average of 50 daily targets and campaigns lasting four days, amplifying Russian influence.
- **Defensive Strategies:** Layered protections including CDNs, WAFs for application-layer filtering, rate limiting, and IP blocking of C2 servers; monitoring threat actor Telegram channels for early warnings, geopolitical intelligence for predictive alerts.